

Info

First, please read the message "IUFO: (Fwd) What UFOs REALLY are" posted by [REDACTED]e. There you will learn why the Secret Government doesn't want Free Energy to be known to the public. Here in this message. I'll share about the scientific basis of Free Energy. You might wonder when you read the message above why public scientists didn't share about them when there is really a basis about Free Energy. The fact is that they do. But they are harassed never endingly by different sectors of society especially elements of the Secret Government in a united effort to prevent the introduction of Free Energy to the public.

What follows is part 1 of 4 about the science of Free Energy written by [REDACTED]g (very interesting stuff I will say). If possible. Cut beginning this part and post these to web sites or forward to mailing lists.

A New Physics for a New Energy Source
by [REDACTED]g

"Today the vacuum [of space] is not regarded as empty.... It is a sea of dynamic energy . . . like the spray of foam near a turbulent waterfall." - [REDACTED], Physicist

[REDACTED]g, a graduate student at the University of Pennsylvania, risked upsetting a committee of engineering professors in 1978 with his proposal for a doctoral thesis topic that energy could be tapped from space. The personable, good humored King had not set out to shock. In fact, as a dutiful systems engineering student, he had at first accepted the standard view that the vacuum of space is useless as an energy source.

However, [REDACTED] had become intrigued with a new idea a couple of summers before, after reading a book about UFOs. In his search through the physics literature for principles that would allow for antigravity, he ran across a concept that interested him even more something called "zero-point energy." It not only allowed for anti-gravity, it also allowed for an abundant source of energy.

WHAT DO THE TEXTBOOKS SAY?

Most scientists and engineers have been taught that the vacuum of space is completely empty and still in the absence of heat, light, and matter. Unless a student is studying quantum mechanics, his or her textbook never mentions zero-point energy.

The quantum mechanics student does learn that the fabric of space consists of random fluctuations of electricity. He or she also learns that these fluctuations are collectively called zero-point energy because they represent the energy that is present even at a temperature of absolute zero, the temperature at which everything is completely cold. It is the energy that exists when all other sources of energy are taken away.

This energy is difficult to detect because it is everywhere. Expecting someone to sense it is like asking a fish to detect the ocean; the fish has no concept of a world that isn't an ocean. Similarly, the fluctuations of electricity that make up space energy are too microscopic and too quick for us to sense them, either with our bodies or with standard detection equipment.

Why did [REDACTED]'s engineering professors fail to teach him about zero-point energy—what we refer to in this book as space energy? The reason is that scientists assume that these vacuum fluctuations simply even out. They call this the second law of thermodynamics, also known as the law of entropy. Under this law, everything is doomed to increasing disorder, until all comes to a dead rest. This means that, according to traditional science, space energy cannot be put to any practical purpose because its randomness cannot be made into an organized system. It would be as if a pile of threads suddenly organized themselves into a shirt.

A NEW ENERGY PHYSICS: MAKING THE IMPOSSIBLE POSSIBLE?

[REDACTED] had found the most impressive reference to zero-point or space energy in a book called Geometrodynamics. The author, noted physicist John Archibald Wheeler, said that this energy foaming within the fabric of space is enormously powerful—if formed into an object, it would put out more energy than a bright star. That's a lot of power.

Does this source of incredible power really interact with our world? King found that there, too, the physics literature held good news.

Quantum mechanics—the branch of science that deals with protons, electrons, and other basic particles of matter—teaches that superhigh-frequency energy does interact with physical matter all the time. It says that these basic particles are mixed with space energy.

The difference between standard quantum mechanics and the ideas of Wheeler and other scientists is that they believed basic particles such as protons and electrons were not only mixed with space energy, they were actually made out of space energy. As [REDACTED] continued to read thrush books on the subject, he began to see energy as a flow, a river from another dimension of space, and basic particles as tiny whirlpools in that river. If the river ceased to flow, the basic particles—the building blocks of all matter—would disappear. So would everyone and everything.

Filled with a sense of awe, King began to see beyond the standard view of space energy as a random jittering of basic particles. He found his newfound ideas confirmed by the work of [REDACTED], a physicist and teacher. Boyer said—contrary to traditional scientific belief—that space energy did influence matter, the physical world around us, and that it wasn't random and meaningless.

Eventually, [REDACTED] realized that if engineers could get only a small part of those random energetic movements in space to line up with each other, they could tap into a tremendous source of power for our everyday world.

COMING UP WITH A NEW COMBINATION OF THEORIES

XXXXX wondered: Why was no one asking if all that power could be harnessed and put to work? The answer seemed to lie in specialization. The people who make machinery and generators to move and heat and power things—the engineers—don't necessarily study quantum mechanics. The people who do study quantum mechanics, the ones who come up with the equations and the formulas—the physicists—don't build machinery.

Even if the majority of neither the engineers nor the physicists were interested in this topic, XXXX was. He still wanted to find out if there was a way to allow for the use of space energy. So the young student set a task for himself. He would stick to the standard physics literature and look for concepts that could be put together to form a body of knowledge a combined theory—about the feasibility of tapping into that abundant energy. He searched through the respected journals and found articles that, taken together, made a case for doing what his professors had said was impossible.

Academia was not particularly interested in space energy at the time, but a growing audience, mostly outside of the ivy walls, snapped up the book that King eventually wrote. Tapping the Zero-Point Energy, first published in 1989, brought together published theories about space energy and theories about the way that natural systems organize themselves. This book laid the groundwork for the development of a coherent theory behind a new source of energy.

>From Chaos To Order

Russian-born scientist XXXXXXXXXX won a Nobel Prize in 1977 for showing how certain systems can evolve from random behavior to orderly behavior. This means that entropy, which assumes that all systems become more and more disordered, is no longer the only game in the universe. It means that energy can indeed be seen as a creative force in space, instead of disorganized chaos. This behavior, the opposite of entropy, has since been called negentropy.

In the 1970s, before and after graduation, Moray King started keeping a foot in two worlds, one in the world of theoretical physics and one in the world of the practical tinkerers who were trying to capture space energy in their home workshops. He was introduced to that second world by new-energy author Christopher Bird, who told King about T. XXXXXXX and XXXXX struggles to capture space energy (see Chapter

3).

New-energy ideas hit XXXX from all sides after that. At first, he wondered if he was being introduced to a bunch of kooks, but he soon came to appreciate these concepts. He kept asking questions, networking and presenting papers at conferences on new-energy technologies, and encouraging inventors to come up with a reproducible experiment to prove that space energy could be tapped.

By 1994, XXXX had further refined his space-energy ideas. At conferences, he explained to eager audiences how vortices-whirlpool-or tornado-like spirals found everywhere in nature - held a key to the energy lock. Give a sudden twist to the nucleus of an atom, and all

its neighbors, and keep spinning them, [REDACTED] said, and you may pull some space energy into your electric-generating system. Rotate the spinning materials [REDACTED] a spin upon a spin [REDACTED] and you have a better chance of picking up some extra energy. Then build pairs of counter-rotating vortices into your system, and you would really have something.

To partially visualize this concept, you can take two yo-yos, twist their strings, and let go so that both yo-yos start spinning. You can then swing the yo-yos in full circles, one forward and one backward. This is the type of motion that might give an inventor a chance to hit the space-energy jackpot.

An Ancient Idea is Reexamined

To more fully understand [REDACTED]'s ideas, it is helpful to go back to a very old concept. Another way of speaking about the background sea of energy is the ancient term prana, later known as the aether. In the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries, the aether was considered to be a substance filling all space, and through which light travelled.

In 1887, two Americans [REDACTED] [REDACTED] tried to detect the aether experimentally. They could not, and concluded that the aether did not exist. About thirty years later, the concept was totally discarded when Albert Einstein put forth his theory of relativity. It says that there is no background structure to the universe, such as an aether. Instead, all objects in the universe, such as stars and planets, affect each other. This means that nothing in space is absolute.

But, as with all theories, there were things that Einstein's theory could not account for. So in 1954, distinguished English physicist P.A.M. Dirac asked science to take another look for the aether: "The aetherless basis of physical theory may have reached the end of its capabilities, and we see in the aether a new hope for the future."

[REDACTED] of Washington state, responded to Dirac's call. In 1986, Silvertooth performed an experiment using laser equipment and his knowledge of advanced optics. By measuring earth's motion in space, he calculated that our solar system is moving toward the constellation of Leo at nearly 400 kilometers a second [REDACTED] or about 892,800 miles an hour. Silvertooth had succeeded where [REDACTED] had failed. The fact that earth's motion in space could be detected meant that there had to be a stable point of reference such as the aether [REDACTED] for this motion to be measured against.

In order for a scientific experiment to be considered valid, it must be successfully repeated. However, Silvertooth used some very expensive equipment, and his research was sponsored in part by the United States Air Force and another defense agency that handles advanced research. To my knowledge, [REDACTED] experiment has not been repeated, although an Austrian physicist has claimed to have also detected the aether.

A Fast-Spinning Vortex?

Today's aether theorists do not see the aether as an invisible fluid filling all of space. Rather, they say it is a spiralling foundation for the universe that cannot be detected by current measuring instruments because its movements are too quick.

XXXXXX is not the only space-energy scientist who thinks that the aether moves in a spiral motion. XXXXXXXXXi, Ph.D., of India is another. He says that the idea of there being enormous levels of power for every square inch of space would be wrong unless that space rotates at a fantastic speed, "like a vortex." He sees the universe as being in motion according to its basic design, with just a concentration of matter here and there a galaxy, a solar system, a planet, an electron.

What makes this movement difficult to detect is the fact that we are moving along with it, and thus have nothing to compare it with. It is like trying to sense the spinning of the earth on its axis because everything is spinning, including us, we do not feel the motion. One scientist describes space energy as two giant, invisible elephants' pushing on both sides of a door. As long as they push with equal force, the door does not move one way or the other.

The aether not only exists, the space energy it produces energizes the earth. To understand how it works, think of a microwave oven. If you put a potato in a microwave, you do not see it cooking, nor do you feel any heat coming from the oven. That's because the microwave cooks the food from the inside out. The oven remains cool, but the inside of the potato becomes very hot. In the same manner, space energy "cooks" the earth's core, which is very hot, while the earth's surface remains relatively cool. The big difference is that the energy in a microwave comes from outward-moving forces of decay, explosion, or combustion, while space energy takes the form of an inward-moving spiral as explained in "Spirals of Energy" on page 13.

Despite a theory that supports a universal abundance of space energy, many engineers cannot let go of their belief in a world ruled by a finite amount of energy. To be fair to the engineers, they don't want to give up that belief because it has worked well as a basis for practical engineering. It is the idea at the heart of the Industrial Age.

However, the new-energy theorists say that space energy does not violate the laws of conservation of energy, which state that energy can be neither created nor destroyed. According to these theorists, this energy has always existed, and thus is not being created out of nothing. It can simply be put to human use. "People are having trouble deciding whether they want to believe it or not," King says.

MAGNETS AND ENERGY

The key to many of the devices that you will be reading about is the magnet. The earth's own magnetic field the one that makes a compass point north may interact somehow with space energy. And new-energy researchers find that the smaller magnetic fields which surround manufactured magnets play a key role in getting their energy-generating hardware to work. Some inventors use super-powerful

magnets made of rare materials, while others use the sorts of ordinary magnets that are found in stereo sound systems.

How exactly do magnets tap into space energy? It is not possible to answer that question with any authority, since scientists are unable to explain exactly what a magnet's force field is—the force that attracts metal objects to the magnet. Nor can they explain exactly what that field interacts with. One electronics engineer says that we are like early humans discovering fire; they knew what it did, but they didn't know why. Many new-energy researchers have come up with differing theories of what makes magnets work. But these theories have not yet jelled into one body of knowledge that is accepted by the scientific establishment.

One thing we do know about magnetism is that it is related to electricity. In the 1830s, English scientist [REDACTED] showed that magnets could be used to produce electricity, and that an electric current produces a magnetic field. While it is not fully understood why this happens, this knowledge has been put to practical use in electric motors and generators. So it is not surprising—if in fact space energy is electric in nature that magnets can be used to capture space energy, even though we don't fully understand how.

MAVERICKS IN HIGH PLACES

In the past decade, [REDACTED] has been joined by scientists around the world in space-energy research, and their results have caused great excitement in the new-energy world. Former astronaut Edgar D. Mitchell, Ph.D., predicted this excitement in 1980 when he said:

"There are types of energy which lie outside the electromagnetic spectrum. Unfortunately, these research efforts have not been given recognition. For the most part, they have been performed by individuals . . . without any support, whose work lies at the threshold of present-day science, and who are years ahead of science which is already established."

The fact that many of space energy's newer proponents are people who have been part of the science establishment means that space energy, long thought of as an oddball idea, will have to be taken seriously.

[REDACTED], Ph.D., of the Institute for Advanced Studies in Austin, Texas, is giving space energy the publicity that Mitchell thought it lacked. [REDACTED] is a scientist whose low-key personality fits into a variety of settings, from security-clearance laboratories to meetings of environmentalists. His background includes corporate work, several years with the United States Department of Defense, and a stint with Stanford Research Institute International. He gives briefings to top government officials and oil industry executives, and to other audiences worldwide.

Puthoff was named Theorist of the Year in 1994 by New Energy News, for a paper that News editor [REDACTED], Ph.D., called the century's most important theoretical paper. Puthoff and two coauthors say that inertia—the tendency of a body in motion to remain in motion, or a body at rest to remain at rest—can be explained by the presence of space energy. [REDACTED] explains by saying it is space energy that

knocks you down if you are standing on a train and the train accelerates quickly from a full stop.

Fox says, "The way the various institutions of science are structured, it is important to work within the system to successfully introduce new scientific theories and facts. This is what [REDACTED] has gently accomplished over the past few years."

[REDACTED], a retired United States Army lieutenant colonel, is a more controversial theorist who is considered to be almost a guru by some in the space-energy field. Bearden believes that present-day mechanical and electrical engineering concepts and mathematics are based on the manipulation of effects, and not of underlying causes, in the same way that a driver can accelerate and deaccelerate a car without understanding how an engine works. The devices made by mainstream engineers do the work they are intended for, he notes, but are crude compared to the hardware that could be made if the deeper causes were understood.

Bearden's quest parallels [REDACTED]'s to learn how to create order in a small part of the seething vacuum of space and put that tremendous energy to work: "We can dip our paddlewheel into that river."

[REDACTED] and [REDACTED] are only two of the many conventionally trained scientists who have found in space-energy theory a new way of seeing the world. And their ideas of theoretical physics are not only important to the world of science. Their ideas form the basis for a technology that will ultimately affect everyone.

In the next chapter we meet inventors who have tried to turn space-energy theory into space-energy devices.

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(Hi, this 2nd message is more interesting than the first one. However, the first is important since it gives the intro about the science of Free Energy. - [REDACTED])

[REDACTED] - Solid-State Magnet Pioneer
by [REDACTED]

"There is suppression launched against any free-energy inventor who succeeds or is very close to succeeding." - Ret. [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

██████████" ████████ created a breakthrough magnetic solid-state energy generator. For complex reasons, he did not develop his device into a commercially viable product. However, as a magnetism specialist with a distinguished industrial career, Sweet was not a man whose technical claims could be easily dismissed by critics.

██████████ story is important for three reasons. First, creditable witnesses saw his invention convert the invisible energy of space into useable amounts of electric power without fuel, batteries, or connection to an outlet. Second, he was subjected to the same kinds of harassment that the inventors we met in Part I had to face, including threats on his life. Third, and most important, Sweet's research has inspired the work of other space-energy inventors, some of whom may well produce a useful stationary-magnetic device.

██████████ AND MAGNETS

██████████ (1912-1995) grew up in Connecticut, in an era when radios were home-built crystal sets. At the age of nine, his intense interest in how things work was directed into building and disassembling radios and other electrical apparatus, such as a small Tesla coil (see Chapter 2) energized by a Model T spark plug.

██████████t was eighteen, a family friend helped him find work at the nearby General Electric plant while he went to college. He got the

nickname "Sparky" after he disconnected some wires one day, which resulted in an instrument exploding in a spectacular spray of sparks. Despite this incident, his employers were pleased with his work especially his intuitive gift for coming up with answers to electrical problems.

Sweet stayed with GE after completing his education. He worked in the company's Schenectady, New York, research and development center from 1957 to 1962—a dream job in which he could use a well equipped laboratory to follow his hunches on intriguing magnetism projects. That line of research fascinated him. In 1969, he obtained a master's degree from the Massachusetts Institute of Technology.

By the mid-1970s, Sweet and his wife, Rose, had moved to the Los Angeles area to enjoy semiretirement. Besides serving as one of GE's preferred consultants, Sweet designed electric equipment for other customers.

██████████ was more than a professional scientist who worked with magnets. He had a passion for magnetism, and for the concept that the entire universe is permeated with a magnetic field. Once he fully retired in the early 1980s, he would have happily spent many hours each day building a device that could tap into the energy of that magnetic field. But ████████ fell ill, and was an invalid for the last seven years of her life. This demanded Floyd's attention and forced him to dip into their savings. He also had to cope with his own ill health, including a period of near blindness. Despite these problems, he worked on his device when not preparing meals and tending to his wife's needs.

SWEET'S VACUUM TRIODE AMPLIFIER: DEFYING CONVENTION

For decades, new-energy researchers talked about the possibility of treating a magnet so that its magnetic field would continuously shake or vibrate. On rare occasions, Sweet saw this effect, called self-oscillation, occur in electric transformers. He felt it could be coaxed into doing something useful, such as producing energy. [REDACTED] thought that if he could find the precise way to shake or disturb a magnet's force field, the field would continue to shake by itself. It would be similar to striking a bell and having the bell keep on ringing.

As usual, [REDACTED]t—who said his ideas came to him in dreams—turned for inspiration to his expertise in magnets. He knew magnets could be used to produce electricity, as we learned in Chapter 4, and wanted to see if he could get power out of a magnet by something other than the standard induction process. That process involves either moving a magnet past a wire coil or a coil of conductive wire, such as copper—or moving a coil through the field of a magnet. This changing magnetic field causes an electric current to flow in the copper wire.

What [REDACTED] wanted to do was to keep the magnet still and just shake its magnetic field. This shaking, in turn, would create an electric current. One new-energy researcher compares self-oscillation to a leaf on a tree waving in a gentle breeze. While the breeze itself isn't moving back and forth, it sets the leaf into that kind of motion. Sweet thought that if space energy, discussed in Chapter 4, could be captured to serve as the breeze, then the magnetic field would serve as the leaf. Sweet would just have to supply a small amount of energy to set the magnetic field in motion, and space energy would keep it moving.

By 1985, he had come up with a set of specially conditioned magnets, wound with wires. To test his device, [REDACTED]t discharged a current into the wire coil around the magnet. As a result, the coil disturbed the magnet's field. It was as if [REDACTED]t had snapped the magnet's Held out of position to set it in motion. [REDACTED]t then connected a twelve-volt lightbulb—the size used in flashlights—to the coil. If the device was producing electricity, the bulb would light.

The results were more than [REDACTED] expected. A surge of power came out of the coil and there was a bright flash from the bulb which had received so much power that it melted. Years later, Sweet remembered that Rose had seen the flash and called out, "What did you blow up now?"

The inventor was baffled by the dazzling flash of light—why so much energy? He returned to his workbench to make further models. Needing a theory to explain his startling discovery, he remembered hearing about Thomas Bearden, retired Army officer and nuclear physicist, and John Bedini, an electronics expert, on a local radio show. [REDACTED]t called Bedini, who arranged for Bearden to visit [REDACTED].

Bearden saw the curious device pull nearly six watts of electric power out of the air with only a tiny fraction of a watt going into the machine. Bearden ran tests to his heart's content, and was delighted to see a little unit embodying the unorthodox concepts that he had

written about over the years, the concepts behind space energy. He called Sweet's assembly of magnets and wire coils the Vacuum Triode Amplifier (VTA). Bearden decided that the device was serving as a gate through which energy from space was being herded into a electric circuit.

The most amazing aspect of [REDACTED] device was that it put out so much more power than it took in. How much more? In a 1988 model, Sweet found that 330 microwatts [REDACTED] 330 one-millionths of a watt [REDACTED] of input power made it possible for the VTA's wire coils to put out more than 500 watts of usable energy, or about one and a half million times the input power.

The VTA's Special Effects and Difficult Development

The VTA turned out to have some very odd effects, but [REDACTED] research background prepared him for that. So in 1987, Bearden asked [REDACTED] to perform an antigravity experiment. Bearden calculated that the six-pound machine would levitate when about 1,500 watts of power were drawn out of it, but that the magnets might explode at about the same power level. He warned Sweet to limit the output to no more than 1,000 watts. A VTA would be placed on a scale so that its weight could be carefully monitored while it was hooked up to a box of lightbulb sockets. Screwing bulbs into the sockets would draw off the power.

About a week later, [REDACTED] excitedly read off results over the phone to Bearden [REDACTED] who was home in Alabama [REDACTED] as [REDACTED] screwed in ten 100-watt bulbs, one at a time. The device gradually lost weight until it was down to 90 percent of its original weight. For safety reasons, Sweet and Bearden stopped the experiment before the device could begin to hover or fly.

Why did the VTA lose weight? According to Bearden's theory, gravity becomes a pushing force rather than a pulling force under certain conditions. Bearden also says that space energy has a pressure, referred to as energy density. If the pressure above an object is decreased while the pressure under the object is increased, the object will be drawn upwards. The VTA may have changed the energy density by drawing on space energy.

The technology could sometimes do spooky things. [REDACTED] of California, a test engineer who has helped many struggling inventors test their devices, recalls an incident that Sweet had told him about. The incident occurred while Sweet was trying to document his

antigravity experiment:

"The machine's weight was observed [to be] decreasing with an increased load [of lightbulbs], in a quiet orderly fashion, until a point was suddenly reached when Floyd heard an immense sound, as if he were at the center of a giant whirlwind but without actual air movement. The sound was heard by Rose in another room of their apartment and by others outside the apartment."

This experience has been confirmed by a Canadian space-energy researcher, who heard a similar whirlwind sound during one of his experiments.

Another unusual effect of Sweet's VTA was the fact that it produced cold, instead of the heat usually generated by electric equipment. The inside of the VTA was as much as twenty degrees cooler than the surrounding air. The greater the load put on the device, the cooler it became. When VTA wires were accidentally shorted out, they flashed with a brilliant burst of light, and were found to be covered with frost. One time, a brief contact with the equipment froze some of Sweet's flesh, causing him pain for about two weeks afterward.

Sweet discovered other interesting effects. But development of the VTA was slowed by trouble with materials and processes, and by financial entanglements. Sweet had to find magnets that could hold the self-oscillation effect. That required magnets with force fields that didn't vary much across the face of the magnet.

Also, standard mathematical calculations didn't work with the VTA. In 1991, Sweet produced a math theory for the VTA—an engineering design model that showed how factors such as the number of turns of wire in the coils affected the device's behavior. Producing this theory was an important step. Without it, other researchers would not reproduce Sweet's work.

Sometimes it was difficult for [REDACTED] to reproduce his own work. As with first models of any new technology, the VTAs he built were very unreliable. For example, at times their output went down at night and picked up again during the day. Sometimes, they just plain stopped working for no apparent reason. But when the VTA worked, the power it put out for its size was unprecedented.

Sweet Challenges the Laws of Physics

[REDACTED] contributed to the theory that explained [REDACTED] invention. Much of the theory that [REDACTED] used to explain how the VTA worked came from advances in the field of phase conjugate optics, a specialized study of light used by laser scientists and weapons researchers. Using information from this field, Bearden said that the VTA was able to amplify the space energy it took in.

The science establishment requires that an invention be explained by accepted laws of physics, and so much output from so little input seems to violate those laws, which do not allow for such a thing. However, Sweet and Bearden recognized that these laws apply to ordinary, or closed, systems—systems in which you cannot get more energy out than what you put in. Because the VTA allowed energy to flow in from the vacuum of space, it was not operating in a closed system, but in an open one. (See Chapter 1 for a discussion of closed versus open systems.) A VTA operating in the flow of space energy is like a windmill operating in the wind. Both receive excess energy from an outside source. But since neither operates in a closed system, neither violates the laws of physics.

In 1991, a paper by [REDACTED] was read at a formal gathering of conventional engineers and physicists in Boston. [REDACTED] nor Sweet were able to attend—Bearden was called away on business, and Sweet was recuperating from heart surgery. [REDACTED] went instead. The paper said that the VTA had the signs of being a true

negentropy device, or a device that was able to turn random space energy into usable electricity (see Chapter 4).

How did this work? It helps to think of a handful of marbles on a tabletop. You can either roll them all in one direction, or you can scatter them in all directions. If you scatter the marbles into a reflector, the reflector will roll them back to you in an orderly fashion. Although the language they used was quite technical, what Sweet and Bearden basically said is that the VTA was able to take

energy "marbles" and keep rolling them back and forth, building energy as they went along.

After [REDACTED] paper was read, [REDACTED] stood up and startled the audience of skeptical engineers: "I have personally seen [REDACTED]'s machine operating. It was running . . . those small motors you saw in the video. It was jump-started with a ninevolt battery. There was no other electrical input required.... There was no connection to the power line whatsoever." And, no, there were no moving parts.

Although most of the audience listened politely, it was too much for one engineering professor. He stalked out of the room, saying, "To present such a remark at an engineering conference is the height of irresponsibility! It violates virtually every conceivable concept known to engineers."

SWEET IS HREATENED

Could activity at the Sweet home been secretly watched by strangers? Sweet told the story of a time in the late 1980s when a man accosted him as Sweet was leaving a supermarket. Sweet remembered the man's expensive-looking shoes, and the fact that he was immaculately dressed. But in the stress of the moment, Sweet couldn't focus on much else.

What made the inventor nervous was the photograph that the man held, a photograph showing [REDACTED] at work on his tabletop-model VTA in the supposed privacy of [REDACTED]'s own home. In what Sweet said was a remarkably clear photo, he was sitting in the dining room on the second story of the apartment building where he lived with Rose.

"He walked me all the way to my building, telling me what would happen to me if I didn't stop my research," Sweet recalled. "How they took that picture through my window, I'll never know." As Sweet remembered it, the man claimed to be connected with a conglomerate that did not want the VTA to come onto the market at that time. He told Sweet, "It is not beyond possibilities to take you out of the way."

Sweet said that afterward he called the FBI in Los Angeles. He believed that two agents staked out his house for a couple of weeks, but that nothing came of it.

Around the time of the photo incident, [REDACTED] was getting telephone calls and death threats from strangers. He said there were "people calling at all hours. The police put a tap on my line and over a six-month period, over 480 calls came in from all parts of the United States. But they were from pay stations." Thus, the police could never

find the callers.

Early in the VTA's development, someone broke into [REDACTED] apartment and stole his notes. He then began to code his notes.

Sweet temporarily stopped work on his invention, out of concern for his ill wife. "They must have known I stopped; they didn't torment me any more."

FOLLOWING IN [REDACTED] FOOTSTEPS

On July 5, 1995, [REDACTED] suffered a fatal heart attack at the age of eighty-three. A couple of weeks before his death, [REDACTED] said that the automotive industry was testing his power unit for use in cars, and that they had a unit running for 5,000 hours. He said he was dealing with people at General Motors, but no one has been able to confirm Sweet's claims.

The VTA itself is bogged down in legal problems. But [REDACTED], who put much of his own time and money into the project, hopes that the VTA can be resurrected so that the world will realize what a pioneer [REDACTED] was. And despite the confusion surrounding Sweet's affairs at the time of his death, other researchers are continuing this line of research.

Confusion and Secrecy

The automotive industry may not have been the only potential investor that [REDACTED] was dealing with. At the time of his death, there was some confusion concerning the rights to Sweet's hardware and papers, held by Sweet's second wife, Violet. Bearden says that Sweet signed a number of agreements with a number of backers, and that some of these people have claimed rights to the invention. At least two of these investors say they want [REDACTED] laboratory equipment, inventions, and technical papers to go into a proposed [REDACTED] Museum so that other researchers could study the technology. [REDACTED] is trying to help all parties work towards an agreement.

[REDACTED]'s urging, [REDACTED] never had the VTA certified by independent testing. "He feared that his life would be snuffed out immediately if he even attempted such a thing," Bearden says.

Sweet also frustrated his fellow researchers by keeping secret his most important process—how he conditioned the magnets that are at the heart of the VTA. Did he pump the magnets with powerful electromagnetic pulses to shake up their internal structure? He refused to give details, and said it wasn't likely that other researchers would learn his secrets: "The odds against them finding out is like trying to open a safe with 100 dials set from zero to a hundred, without knowing the combination."

[REDACTED] not only feared for his life, but once said he feared that if he described how he made his device work, unscrupulous people would build models without giving him his due. He was also concerned about what would happen if the VTA was widely sold everywhere at once, replacing many other electric devices. "If it all came out at once, the stock market would collapse," he said. "The government doesn't want it." To